

006. Chapter 2 Verses 17-18

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.17

अविनाशि तु तद्विद्धि येन सर्वमिदं ततम् ।
विनाशमव्ययस्यास्य न कश्चित्कर्तुमर्हति ॥ 17 ॥

avināśhi tu tadviddhi yena sarvam idaṁ tatam
vināśham avyayasyāsyā na kaśhchit kartum arhati

avināśhi—indestructible; tu—indeed; tat—that; viddhi—know; yena—by whom;
sarvam—entire; idam—this; tatam—pervaded; vināśham—destruction;
avyayasya—of the imperishable; asya—of it; na kaśhchit—no one; kartum—to
cause; arhati—is able

(O Arjuna!) Know that Atma by which the whole universe is pervaded is indestructible. No one can cause the destruction of the imperishable.

VERSE 2.18

अन्तवन्त इमे देहा नित्यस्योक्ताः शरीरिणः ।
अनाशिनोऽप्रमेयस्य तस्माद्युध्यस्व भारत ॥ 18 ॥

antavanta ime dehā nityasyuktāḥ śharīriṇaḥ
anāśhino 'prameyasya tasmād yudhyasva bhārata

anta-vantaḥ—having an end; **ime**—these; **dehāḥ**—material bodies; **nityasya**—eternally; **uktāḥ**—are said; **śharīriṇaḥ**—of the embodied soul; **anāśhinaḥ**—indestructible; **aprameyasya**—immeasurable; **tasmāt**—therefore; **yudhyasva**—fight; **bhārata**—descendant of Bharat, Arjun

**These bodies which belong to the real imperishable,
unknowable Atma are said to be subject to an end; therefore
fight, O Arjuna!**